

Unfortunately, Windows 7 doesn't provide a direct Upgrade path for Windows XP users, and you have to go through the whole process of backing up your data, formatting and installing Windows, and then restoring your files and settings using the 'User State Migration Tool' which moves all your desktop, application and system settings apart from your files to a new Windows installation. It is kind of like Microsoft's punishment for skipping Vista, but Microsoft has made sure not to alienate XP users and they've provided a series of videos detailing how to migrate from XP to Windows 7 on their website.

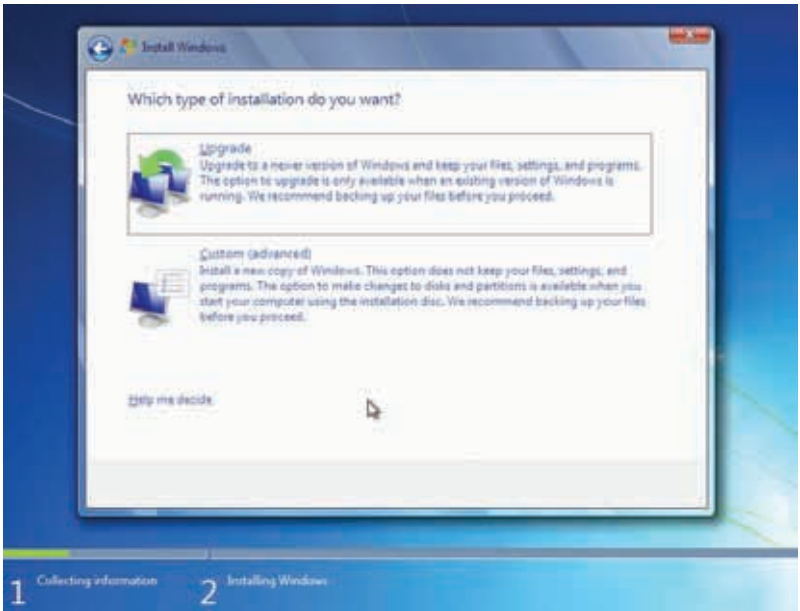
Let us get down to installing Windows.

2.1 What are your options?

You've two options from the default installer:

Upgrade to Windows 7 – This option upgrades your current operating system and keeps your files, settings and programs as they are presently.

Install Windows by performing a custom installation – This option is used to completely replace your current operating system, or to install



Your options for installing Windows 7